ever before.

The mid-1870s saw another disaster in the form of famines, and the Famine Commission, constituted by the government in 1880, insisted on the building of more railway lines, of smaller gauge, wherever major lines could not go. '5,000 miles of lines are urgently needed,' said the Commission Report. [73]

The 1870s ended with the Second Anglo-Afghan War (1878–1880), which led to more strategic planning. George Robinson, First Marquess of Ripon, more popular as Lord Ripon, took over as Governor General in 1880. He was serious about strategic lines, and pushed for their construction. By the end of 1892, the total route mileage of railways in India was 18,000 miles; and between 1850 and 1892, new railway lines in India were opening up at an average of 430 miles a year. [74] Now that is some speed!

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[66] A. Ramarao, 'Spread of Railways: The Revolt of 1857, Rail Heritage Journal,' http://railwaysofraj.blogspot.in/2010/09/spread-of-railways-revolt-of-1857.html

[67] Ibid

[68] *The Illustrated London News* (Saturday, Jan 2, 1858) vol.32, no.896, p.5

[69] Veena Talwar, 'The City Must Be Safe—Communications,' *The Making of Colonial Lucknow , 1856 –1877* (Oldenburg, Princeton University Press, New Jersey, 1984), chap.2, pp.43–46.

[70] A magazine is an ammunition storage place, which was planned beside the station.

[71] Veena Talwar, 'The City Must Be Safe—Communications,' *The Making of Colonial Lucknow , 1856-1877* (Oldenburg, Princeton University Press New Jersey, 1984)

[72] F.R. Hemingway, 'Means of Communication,' Madras District Gazetteers, Trichinopoly, vol. 1, (Government Press: 1907) chap.7, p.183.

[73] J.N. Sahni, 'A Network is Built' and 'Growth of Companies', *Indian Railways—One Hundred Years: 1853-1953* (Ministry of Railways, 1953) chap.2 & 3, pp.14–22

[74] J.N. Sahni, 'A Network is Built' and 'Growth of Companies', *Indian Railways—One Hundred Years: 1853–1953* (Ministry of Railways, 1953) chap.2 & 3, pp.14–22